

Privacy Policy Update Diff

2026-06-01

Section	2024-01-13 (Previous)	2026-06-01 (Current)
Our Contact Details	Name: CompSoc BetterInformatics Address: CompSoc, School of Informatics, Informatics Forum, 10 Crichton Street, Edinburgh, EH8 9AB. Email: admin@betterinformatics.com	Name: CompSoc Better Informatics Address: CompSoc, School of Informatics, Informatics Forum, 10 Crichton Street, Edinburgh, EH8 9AB. Email: admin@betterinformatics.com
Types of personal information collected	We currently collect and process the following information: • Student UUN (i.e. username) • IP Address (stored ephemerally during login)	We currently collect and process the following information: • Student UUN (i.e. username) • IP Address (stored ephemerally during login) • Account creation date • Last login date • Anonymised browsing behaviour on the platform such as visited pages and time spent on each page • Your activity, such as upvotes, downvotes, reports • Your dissertation details and full contents, if you choose to submit them • Any other information you intentionally share on the platform through public content submissions
How we get the personal information and why we have it	All of the personal information we process is provided to us directly by you for authentication and identification purposes. We use the information that you have given us in order to limit access to BetterInformatics File Collection and its community-provided documents to current University of Edinburgh students. Under the UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR), the lawful bases we rely on for processing this information are: • Your consent. You are able to remove your consent at any time. You can do this by contacting us at admin@betterinformatics.com to request the deletion of your account.	Your Student UUN and IP address are provided to us directly by you or your browser for authentication and identification purposes. We use the information that you have given us in order to limit access to Better Informatics and its community-provided documents to current University of Edinburgh students. Under the UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR), the lawful bases we rely on for processing this information are: • Contractual necessity. In order to provide the features we promise to our users including you, we need to verify using your UUN that you are a current University of Edinburgh student. Furthermore, we use your IP address to detect and prevent malicious login attempts in order to maintain the availability of our service. Your account creation date is automatically generated by our system when you create an account, and your last login date is automatically updated by our system whenever you log in. We use the information that you have given us to track user growth. As gradually students lose access to their university accounts after graduation, we also use the last login date to estimate accounts of graduated users that we can exclude from our active user metrics. Under the UK GDPR, the lawful bases we rely on for processing this information are: • Legitimate interests. We have a legitimate interest in tracking the growth of our user base in order to decide how much resources to invest in maintaining and improving our service. You have the right to object to the processing of this information, and you can do so at any time. As some of this information is structural to our database, we may not be able to delete it

		upon request, but we can exclude it from our user metrics. Please contact us at admin@betterinformatics.com. Your anonymised browsing behaviour on the platform is tracked by our system automatically via JavaScript. We use this information to understand browsing behaviour on our platform to target development priorities. Under the UK GDPR, the lawful bases we rely on for processing this information are: • Legitimate interests. We have a legitimate interest in understanding how users browse our platform in order to prioritise which site pages to focus UX improvements on. You have the right to object to the processing of this information, and you can do so at any time. Please contact us at admin@betterinformatics.com. Your activity on the platform, such as upvotes, downvotes, and reports, are tracked and stored by our system when you interact with the relevant features. We use this information for curating the content displayed on our platform, which benefits the community. Under the UK GDPR, the lawful bases we rely on for processing this information are: • Legitimate interests. We have a legitimate interest in curating the content on our platform in order to operate, maintain, and preserve a primarily community-driven knowledge archive for the benefit of current and future students. You have the right to object to the processing of this information, and you can do so at any time. You can do this by ceasing to use the relevant features, which are not required for the core offering of Better Informatics. For a manual alternative, you can contact us at admin@betterinformatics.com. Your dissertation details and full contents, if you choose to submit them, are provided to us directly by you for the purpose of creating a searchable database of volunteer-contributed past dissertations. You may choose to redact some words from your dissertation when you upload it. You may choose to not upload your dissertation at all. The entire offering of Better Informatics is available to you regardless of whether you upload one or not. Under the UK GDPR, the lawful bases we rely on for processing this information are: • Legitimate interests. Should you choose to submit your dissertation, we have a legitimate interest in processing that information for the purpose of achieving our mission as a provider of a community-driven knowledge archive. You have the right to object to the processing of this information, and you can do so at any time. You can do this by deleting the dissertation that you have uploaded, which instantly removes the information and files from our servers. For a manual alternative, you can contact us at admin@betterinformatics.com.
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		Any other information you share on the platform through free-form submissions such as resources, answers, comments, and course reviews, are provided to us directly by you by your own judgement and help us build a community-driven platform. We discourage the sharing of overly personal information through these channels, as some of them will be made public to the internet without authentication. The entire offering of Better Informatics is available to you regardless of your inclusion of personal information. Under the UK GDPR, the lawful bases we rely on for processing this information are: Legitimate interests. Should you choose to make a submission containing personal information, we have a legitimate interest in processing it and sharing it with other users for the purpose of achieving our mission as a provider of a community-driven knowledge. Specifically with regards to resources and reviews, this may also extend to sharing the content with the wider internet without authentication. You have the right to object to the processing of this information, and you can do so at any time. You can do this by deleting the relevant submission. For a manual alternative, you can contact us at admin@betterinformatics.com.
How we store your personal information	Your student UUN and any contributed data are securely stored on our servers hosted in Edinburgh by the Tardis Project. We will keep these until you request the deletion of your account. Your IP address is only stored ephemerally during the login request in order to email the verification code to the associated email. This info is used to track down any malicious attempts to login to your account.	Your IP address is only stored ephemerally during the login request in order to perform security checks. After the login request is completed, the IP address is deleted from our servers. Your student UUN and all other contributed data are securely stored on our servers hosted physically in Edinburgh by the Tardis Project. Because these data form a permanent educational resource that is integral to the platform, we will keep these indefinitely. If you choose to delete your account, your personal identifiers (such as your student UUN) will be scrubbed, but your contributed content will be retained in an anonymised format unless you specifically request their deletion too. Additionally, an encrypted backup of all data including your personal information is stored on cloud storage services. This is to ensure that we can recover production data in the event of Tardis (our host) experiencing data loss. The encryption key is known to and managed by only the Better Informatics server administrator(s).
Your data protection rights	Under data protection law, you have rights including: Your Right of Access - You have the right to ask us for copies of your personal information. Your Right to Erasure - You have the right to ask us to erase your personal information. Your Right to Restrict Processing - You have the right to ask us to restrict the processing of your personal information. Your Right to Object to Processing - You have the right to object to the processing of your personal information.	Under data protection law, you have rights including: Your Right to Access & Data Portability - You have the right to receive your personal information in a structured, commonly used format. Your Right to Erasure - You have the right to ask us to erase your personal information. Your Right to Restrict or Object to Processing - You have the right to object to the processing of your personal information and/or request restrictions on such processing. Your Right to Lodge a Complaint - You have the right to lodge a complaint with the UK Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) if you believe that your data protection rights have been infringed.

	You are not required to pay any charge for exercising your rights. If you make a request, we have one month to respond to you. Please contact us at admin@betterinformatics.com	• Your Right to Rectification - You have the right to ask us to rectify inaccurate personal information we hold about you. All functionality of Better Informatics with an upload or contribution feature has an associated delete or edit feature. You are not required to pay any charge for exercising your rights. If you make a request, we have one month to respond to you. Please contact us at admin@betterinformatics.com.
How to complain	If you have any concerns about our use of your personal information, you can make a complaint to us at admin@betterinformatics.com.	If you have any concerns about our use of your personal information, you can make a complaint to us at admin@betterinformatics.com.
History of Changes to this Policy		• 2024-01-13: Initial revision • 2026-06-01: Updated privacy policy